SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

10 August 2021 · Shift 3

67 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 33 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Break the ice

(A) Make a beginning or start something
(B) Cool the room for everyone
(C) Arrange for a skating show
(D) Make things available for a party

Q.2

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. "Regard of whether" the students were ready or not the teacher announced the dates of the test.

(A) Regarding whether
(B) Regardless of whatsoever
(C) No substitution required
(D) Regardless of whether

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Silt

(A) Cut
(B) Opening
(C) Residue
(D) Incision

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Suceed
(B) Inherit
(C) Implant
(D) Accede

Q.5

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. The arrangement of events or dates in the order of their occurrence.

(A) Calendar
(B) Chronology
(C) Chronic
(D) Routine

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Vacillate

(A) Augment
(B) Waver
(C) Strengthen
(D) Fortify

Q.7

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. The country gained admission to the United Nations in 1955. B. In 2008, however, after a decade long period of violence and turbulent negotiation with a strong Maoist insurgency, the monarchy was dissolved, and Nepal was declared a democratic republic. C. In 1991 the kingdom established a multiparty parliamentary system. D. Nepal, long under the rule of hereditary prime ministers favouring a policy of isolation, remained closed to the outside world until a palace revolt in 1950 restored the crown's authority in 1951.

(A) BCDA
(B) DACB
(C) DBAC
(D) CABD

Q.8

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Vidya put on her mask, / sanitise her hands / and walked into the shop.

(A) and walked into the shop
(B) No error
(C) Vidya put on her mask
(D) sanitise her hands

Q.9

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Rigid

(A) Definite
(B) Flexible
(C) Adamant
(D) Firm

Q.10

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Ravi drove the car towards the highway for a trial run.

(A) The car was driving towards the highway for a trial run by Ravi.
(B) The car had driven towards the highway for a trial run by Ravi.
(C) The car had been driven for a trial run by Ravi towards the highway.
(D) The car was driven towards the highway for a trial run by Ravi.

Q.11

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the right order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A. First, a new article comes into our offices. B. Every article in the Encyclopedia goes through a rigorous editorial process to make sure it's clear, accurate, objective and fair. C. The article is first reviewed by a fact checker, who uses a variety of sources to make sure the article is accurate and the facts are correct. D. The author may be an editor at the Encyclopedia who knows that subject or a prominent scholar with specialised expertise in that field.

(A) BADC
(B) BCAD
(C) CDAB
(D) CADB

Q.12

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. As the Principal was busy, she _____ a senior teacher to attend the conference on her behalf.

(A) Reserved
(B) Declared
(C) Deputed
(D) Committed

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. If a person tests positive for Covid-19, "he have to isolate himself" immediately so that he does not infect others.

(A) he must have to isolate
(B) he isolated himself
(C) he has to isolate himself
(D) No substitution required

Q.14

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech. The customer asked the bank manager if they were working on the following Saturday.

(A) The customer asked the bank manager, "Are they working on the previous Saturday?"
(B) The customer said to the bank manager, "Are you working next Saturday?"
(C) The customer asks the bank manager, "If you were working on the following Saturday?"
(D) The customer said to the bank manager, "Were they working on the previous Saturday?"

Q.16

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Your advices were timely / and guided me / to take the right decisions.

(A) to take the right decisions
(B) No error
(C) and guided me
(D) Your advices were timely

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Inept

(A) Partial
(B) Lacking
(C) Competent
(D) Useless

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A lean patch

(A) Cloth that is beginning to tear
(B) A part of hair that is thin
(C) Friendship that has ended
(D) A period of poor performance

Q.19

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A place of ideal perfection especially in laws, government, and social conditions

(A) Paradise
(B) Heaven
(C) Utopia
(D) Aden

Q.20

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Carbohydrates are so called because they _____ carbon, oxygen and hydrogen.

(A) contain
(B) cover
(C) consist
(D) codify

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Seychelles, one of the world's smallest countries, is (1)_____ of two main island groups: the Mahé group of (2)_____ than 40 central, mountainous granitic islands and a (3)_____ group of more than 70 outer, flat, coralline islands. The islands of the Mahé group are rocky and (4)_____ have a narrow coastal strip and a central range of hills. The (5)_____ feature of those islands, with their lush tropical vegetation, is that of high hanging gardens overlooking silver-white beaches and clear lagoons.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) Covered
(B) Composed
(C) Contained
(D) Combined

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Seychelles, one of the world's smallest countries, is (1)_____ of two main island groups: the Mahé group of (2)_____ than 40 central, mountainous granitic islands and a (3)_____ group of more than 70 outer, flat, coralline islands. The islands of the Mahé group are rocky and (4)_____ have a narrow coastal strip and a central range of hills. The (5)_____ feature of those islands, with their lush tropical vegetation, is that of high hanging gardens overlooking silver-white beaches and clear lagoons.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) Further
(B) Beyond
(C) Extra
(D) More

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Seychelles, one of the world's smallest countries, is (1)_____ of two main island groups: the Mahé group of (2)_____ than 40 central, mountainous granitic islands and a (3)_____ group of more than 70 outer, flat, coralline islands. The islands of the Mahé group are rocky and (4)_____ have a narrow coastal strip and a central range of hills. The (5)_____ feature of those islands, with their lush tropical vegetation, is that of high hanging gardens overlooking silver-white beaches and clear lagoons.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) Succeeding
(B) Next
(C) Second
(D) Subsequent

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Seychelles, one of the world's smallest countries, is (1)_____ of two main island groups: the Mahé group of (2)_____ than 40 central, mountainous granitic islands and a (3)_____ group of more than 70 outer, flat, coralline islands. The islands of the Mahé group are rocky and (4)_____ have a narrow coastal strip and a central range of hills. The (5)_____ feature of those islands, with their lush tropical vegetation, is that of high hanging gardens overlooking silver-white beaches and clear lagoons.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) Typically
(B) Routinely
(C) Regularly
(D) Habitually

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Seychelles, one of the world's smallest countries, is (1)_____ of two main island groups: the Mahé group of (2)_____ than 40 central, mountainous granitic islands and a (3)_____ group of more than 70 outer, flat, coralline islands. The islands of the Mahé group are rocky and (4)_____ have a narrow coastal strip and a central range of hills. The (5)_____ feature of those islands, with their lush tropical vegetation, is that of high hanging gardens overlooking silver-white beaches and clear lagoons.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) Collective
(B) Wide
(C) Predominant
(D) Global

General Intelligence 18 questions

Q.1

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
8, 11, 17, 26, 38, ?

(A) 53
(B) 56
(C) 50
(D) 58

Q.2

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of numbers. 56 : 67

(A) 49 : 58
(B) 85 : 98
(C) 76 : 88
(D) 63 : 75

Q.3

Train A, which runs at a speed of 90 km/h, starts from Station Y at 8 a.m. Train B, which runs at a speed of 120 km/h, starts from Station Y on the same route at 8.10 a.m.. If Train B catches up with Train A at 8.40 a.m. at Station Z, then what is the distance between Stations Y and Z?

(A) 54 km
(B) 62 km
(C) 60 km
(D) 50 km

Q.4

Sunaina introduced Ritik as the son of the brother of her mother. How is Ritik related to Sunaina?

(A) Son
(B) Cousin
(C) Uncle
(D) Nephew

Q.7

In a certain code language, TOGETHER is coded as 119 and MASTER is coded as 87. How will REVERSE be coded in that language?

(A) 92
(B) 98
(C) 94
(D) 96

Q.8

Four letter-clusters have been given in the options, out of which three letter-clusters are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

(A) GDBY
(B) UROL
(C) QNKH
(D) JGDA

Q.9

In a certain code language, TRAILER is written as QPXGICO. How will ALMIRAH be written in that language?

(A) XIJFOXE
(B) YJKGPYF
(C) YIKFPXF
(D) XJJGOYE

Q.10

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. 32 : 63 : 123

(A) 26 : 48 : 92
(B) 26 : 51 : 100
(C) 35 : 72 : 149
(D) 33 : 66 : 130

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Hollow : Worthless : : Solid : ?

(A) Sound
(B) Sincere
(C) Acceptance
(D) Clear

Q.13

Four words have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the word that is different.

(A) Confident
(B) Intelligent
(C) Coward
(D) Honest

Q.16

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All bats are sticks. All sticks are woods. Conclusions: I. Some woods are not bats. II. All bats are woods.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Only conclusion II follows.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.19

Select the option that is related to the third word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word. Sacred : Profane : : Barren : ?

(A) Fertile
(B) Desert
(C) Empty
(D) Sterile

Q.20

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in a logical and meaningful order. 1. Beam 2. Canopy 3. Foundation 4. Roof 5. Column

(A) 3-2-1-5-4
(B) 3-5-1-4-2
(C) 1-2-5-3-4
(D) 5-3-1-2-4

Q.21

Which two digits and two signs need to be interchanged so as to balance the given equation? 98 ÷ 4 – 126 + 96 × 5 = 266

(A) 8 and 2; – and +
(B) 5 and 8; × and ÷
(C) 5 and 9; + and ÷
(D) 6 and 4; × and ÷

Q.22
Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term.
COMPETE : OCETPME : : EXTREME : ?

(A) EMXEERT
(B) RTXEEME
(C) XEEMRTE
(D) XERTMEE

Q.23
Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set.
(92, 85, 82)

(A) (28, 23, 21)
(B) (71, 65, 62)
(C) (83, 78, 77)
(D) (69, 66, 62)

Q.24
Four numbers have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number that is different.

(A) 199
(B) 139
(C) 183
(D) 163

Q.25
Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. t _ f e t c _ _ _ c f e

(A) t c f e
(B) f e t c
(C) e c f t
(D) c f e t

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Who among the following rulers belonged to the Tuluva dynasty?

(A) Pushyamitra Sunga
(B) Vishnuvardhana
(C) Simha Vishnu
(D) Krishnadeva Raya

Q.2
Where was the first hot air balloon wildlife safari launched in India in December 2020?

(A) Palamu Tiger Reserve
(B) Ranthambore Tiger Reserve
(C) Bandhavgarh Tiger Reserve
(D) Pilibhit Tiger Reserve

Q.3
Which of the following quantities is measured using a torsion balance?

(A) Magnetism
(B) Charge
(C) Pressure
(D) Force

Q.4
Who among the following cricketers won the Sir Garfield Sobers Award for ‘ICC Male Cricketer of the Decade’ in December 2020?

(A) Steve Smith
(B) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
(C) Virat Kohli
(D) Rashid Khan

Q.5

Who among the following were awarded the Nobel Prize in Chemistry 2020 for their exemplary work in genome editing?

(A) Jennifer A Doudna and Emmanuelle Charpentier
(B) George P Smith and Sir Gregory P Winter
(C) Gerard Mourou and Donna Strickland
(D) James P Allison and Tasuku Honjo

Q.6

Which of the following crops is grown throughout the year in the southern states of India?

(A) Sorghum
(B) Maize
(C) Finger millet
(D) Rice

Q.7

Who among the following travellers came to India from Uzbekistan in the 11th century?

(A) Abdur Razzaq Samarquandi
(B) Francois Bernier
(C) Ibn Battuta
(D) Al-Biruni

Q.8

Which of the following states was NOT formed in the year 2000?

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Telangana
(C) Uttarakhand
(D) Chhattisgarh

Q.9

Which of the following songs do the peasants of Rajasthan sing while working in fields?

(A) Pankhida
(B) Pandavani
(C) Chhakri
(D) Barhamasa

Q.10

The total population per net cultivated area of a country refers to its _____.

(A) physiological density
(B) population density
(C) agricultural density
(D) livestock density

Q.11

Who among the following won a bronze medal at the World Athletics Championship in Paris in 2003?

(A) Krishna Poonia
(B) Seema Punia
(C) PT Usha
(D) Anju Bobby George

Q.12

Which of the following soils is found in areas of heavy rainfall and high humidity?

(A) Saline soil
(B) Peaty soil
(C) Red soil
(D) Yellow soil

Q.13

An ambassador of which of the following countries was elected as the President of the United Nations Human Rights Council in January 2021?

(A) Cuba
(B) Libya
(C) Fiji
(D) Ghana

Q.14
In which of the following states is the Shatrunjaya Hills located?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Karnataka

Q.15
In which of the following years did the Reserve Bank of India liberalise the licensing policy for Urban Co-operative Banks?

(A) 1993
(B) 1998
(C) 1995
(D) 2001

Q.16
The _____ is a three or four letter abbreviation that signifies the file type.

(A) extension
(B) search
(C) virus
(D) name

Q.17
Which of the following books did the famous cricketer Sunil Gavaskar author?

(A) Democracy’s XI: The Great Indian Cricket Story
(B) Runs 'n Ruins
(C) Playing It My Way
(D) Captain Cool

Q.18
As per Union Budget 2020, the Government of India intends to double the country's milk processing capacity by the year _____.

(A) 2028
(B) 2023
(C) 2030
(D) 2025

Q.19
Which of the following ports is used to connect a computer to a wired network?

(A) Universal serial bus port
(B) Ethernet port
(C) Parallel port
(D) Super-video port

Q.20
Which of the following is a vector-borne disease?

(A) Pneumonia
(B) Malaria
(C) Mumps
(D) Cholera

Q.21
Which of the following states launched India's and South-Asia's first blockchain-enabled rooftop solar trading platform in December 2020?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Gujarat
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.22
Who is the Governor of the state of Chhattisgarh as of May 2020?

(A) Bhupesh Baghel
(B) Anusuiya Uikey
(C) Phagu Chauhan
(D) Ramesh Bais

Q.23

Which of the following cells is NOT used in watches?

(A) Silver oxide cell
(B) Mercury cell
(C) Zinc air cell
(D) Lead acid cell

Q.24

Where is the Rumi Darwaza located?

(A) Lucknow
(B) Gwalior
(C) Agra
(D) Bhopal

Q.25

In December 2020, the Chief Minister of _____ announced that India's biggest hockey stadium is being set up in the state.

(A) Telangana
(B) Odisha
(C) West Bengal
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (A) Make a beginning or start something

To 'break the ice' is to make a start, easing the awkwardness at the beginning of a meeting or conversation.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Regardless of whether

'Regardless of whether' (without considering whether) is the set phrase; 'regard of whether' is not idiomatic.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Residue

'Silt' is the fine sand and clay that flowing water carries and leaves behind: a 'residue'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Suceed

The correct spelling is 'succeed'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Chronology

Chronology is the arrangement of events in the order in which they happened. 'Chronic' means long-lasting.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Waver

To 'vacillate' is to keep changing one's mind: to 'waver'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) DACB

D introduces Nepal and its history up to 1951; A (1955), C (1991) and B (2008, 'however') follow in order of date: DACB.

Q.8 · Answer (D) sanitise her hands

The three actions are in sequence and must share the past tense: 'put on her mask, sanitised her hands and walked into the shop'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Flexible

'Rigid' means stiff and unbending; its opposite is 'flexible'. 'Firm' and 'adamant' are near synonyms.

Q.10 · Answer (D) The car was driven towards the highway for a trial run by Ravi.

The simple past 'drove' becomes 'was driven', with the rest of the sentence kept in order and the agent 'by Ravi' at the end.

Q.11 · Answer (A) BADC

B introduces the editorial process, A begins it ('First, a new article comes'), D describes the article's author and C the review by a fact checker: BADC.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Deputed

To 'depute' someone is to appoint them to act on one's behalf.

Q.13 · Answer (C) he has to isolate himself

The singular subject 'he' takes 'has': 'he has to isolate himself'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) The customer said to the bank manager, “Are you working next Saturday?”

In direct speech 'asked' becomes 'said to', 'they were working' returns to 'Are you working', and 'the following Saturday' becomes 'next Saturday'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Your advices were timely

'Advice' is uncountable and takes a singular verb: 'Your advice was timely'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Competent

'Inept' means lacking skill; its opposite is 'competent'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) A period of poor performance

A 'lean patch' is a period of poor performance or little success.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Utopia

A utopia is an imagined place or state where everything, its laws, government and society included, is perfect.

Q.20 · Answer (A) contain
Carbohydrates 'contain' carbon, hydrogen and oxygen; 'consist' would need 'of'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Composed
'Is composed of' means is made up of: Seychelles is made up of two main island groups.

Q.22 · Answer (D) More
'More than 40' gives the number of islands, as 'more than 70' does later in the sentence.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Second
The passage names two groups: the Mahé group and 'a second group' of outer, coralline islands.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Typically
'Typically' means as is characteristic: the rocky islands usually have a narrow coastal strip. 'Routinely', 'regularly' and 'habitually' describe repeated actions, not features.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Predominant
'Predominant' means main or most noticeable: the islands' chief feature is their high hanging gardens.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (A) 53
The differences are 3, 6, 9, 12, so the next is 15: 38 + 15 = 53.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 85 : 98
The second number is the first plus the sum of its digits: 56 + 5 + 6 = 67. Likewise 85 + 8 + 5 = 98.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 60 km
From 8.10 to 8.40 a.m. Train B runs for half an hour at 120 km/h: 60 km. (Train A, in 40 minutes at 90 km/h, has also covered 60 km.)

Q.4 · Answer (B) Cousin
The son of her mother's brother is the son of Sunaina's maternal uncle: her cousin.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 98
Each letter takes the place of its opposite in the alphabet (A = 26, B = 25, ..., Z = 1) and 1 is added to the total: MASTER = 14 + 26 + 8 + 7 + 22 + 9 + 1 = 87. REVERSE = 9 + 22 + 5 + 22 + 9 + 8 + 22 + 1 = 98.

Q.8 · Answer (A) GDBY
In UROL, QNKH and JGDA each letter is 3 places before the one before it. GDBY moves –3, –2, –3 (B back to Y wrapping round), so it is the odd one.

Q.9 · Answer (D) XJJGOYE
The letters move back 3 and 2 places in turn: T → Q, R → P, A → X, I → G, L → I, E → C, R → O. So A → X, L → J, M → J, I → G, R → O, A → Y, H → E: XJJGOYE.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 26 : 48 : 92
Each number is twice the one before it minus the difference between that number's digits: 32 × 2 – (3 – 2) = 63 and 63 × 2 – (6 – 3) = 123. Likewise 26 × 2 – (6 – 2) = 48 and 48 × 2 – (8 – 4) = 92.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Sound
Said of a promise or an argument, 'hollow' means worthless and 'solid' means sound: each pair are words of similar meaning.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Coward
Confident, intelligent and honest are adjectives naming good qualities; 'coward' is a noun, and names a weakness.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Only conclusion II follows.
All bats are sticks and all sticks are woods, so all bats are woods (II). I need not follow: every wood might be a bat.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Fertile
'Profane' is the opposite of 'sacred', as 'fertile' is the opposite of 'barren'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 3-5-1-4-2
A building rises from its foundation (3) through columns (5) and beams (1) to the roof (4), with a canopy (2), a projecting cover, added last.

Q.21 · Answer (B) 5 and 8; × and ÷
Interchanging 5 and 8 and × and ÷: 95 × 4 – 126 + 96 ÷ 8 = 380 – 126 + 12 = 266.

Q.22 · Answer (C) XEEMRTE
The letters are taken in the order 2, 1, 5, 6, 4, 3, 7: C O M P E T E gives O C E T P M E. So E X T R E M E gives X E E M R T E.

Q.23 · Answer (C) (83, 78, 77)
Each number is the one before it minus the difference between that number's digits: 92 – (9 – 2) = 85 and 85 – (8 – 5) = 82. Likewise 83 – (8 – 3) = 78 and 78 – (8 – 7) = 77.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 183
199, 139 and 163 are prime numbers; 183 = 3 × 61 is not.

Q.25 · Answer (D) c f e t
With c, f, e, t in the blanks the block tcfe repeats: tcfe tcfe tcfe.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Krishnadeva Raya
Krishnadeva Raya (ruled 1509-1529) was the greatest king of the Tuluva dynasty, the third of Vijayanagara's dynasties. Pushyamitra founded the Sunga dynasty and Simhavishnu was a Pallava king.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Bandhavgarh Tiger Reserve
On 25 December 2020 Madhya Pradesh launched India's first hot air balloon safari in a tiger reserve, at Bandhavgarh Tiger Reserve in Umaria district.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Force
A torsion balance measures very small forces from the twist of a fine fibre: Coulomb used one for the force between charges and Cavendish for the gravitational force between masses.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Virat Kohli
Virat Kohli received the Sir Garfield Sobers Award for ICC Male Cricketer of the Decade in the ICC Awards of the Decade, announced in December 2020.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Jennifer A Doudna and Emmanuelle Charpentier
Emmanuelle Charpentier and Jennifer A. Doudna won the 2020 prize for developing CRISPR/Cas9, the 'genetic scissors' used for genome editing.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Rice
NCERT's table of cropping seasons lists rice in the kharif, rabi and zaid seasons in the southern states, whose warm climate allows two or three crops of rice a year.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Al-Biruni
Al-Biruni, from Khwarizm (in present-day Uzbekistan), came to India in the 11th century with Mahmud of Ghazni and wrote 'Kitab-ul-Hind'. Ibn Battuta came in the 14th century, Abdur Razzaq in the 15th and Bernier in the 17th.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Telangana
Telangana was formed from Andhra Pradesh on 2 June 2014. Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand (then Uttaranchal) and Jharkhand were all formed in November 2000.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Pankhida
SSC's key gives Pankhida, which folk-music references describe as a song that Rajasthan's peasants sing while working in the fields. Pandavani is Chhattisgarh's sung narration of the Mahabharata and Chhakri a Kashmiri folk form.

Q.10 · Answer (A) physiological density
Physiological density is the total population divided by the net cultivated area. Agricultural density counts only the agricultural population, and population density divides by the total area.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Anju Bobby George
Anju Bobby George won bronze in the long jump at the 2003 World Championships in Paris, India's first medal at the World Athletics Championships.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Peaty soil
NCERT describes peaty soils as found in areas of heavy rainfall and high humidity, where thick vegetation leaves a large amount of dead organic matter in the soil.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Fiji
Nazhat Shameem Khan, Fiji's ambassador in Geneva, was elected President of the UN Human Rights Council for 2021 in January 2021.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Gujarat
The Shatrunjaya Hills, crowded with Jain temples, rise above Palitana in Bhavnagar district, Gujarat.

Q.15 · Answer (A) 1993
The RBI liberalised the licensing of new urban co-operative banks in May 1993, adopting the recommendations of the Marathe Committee (1992) and prescribing entry-point norms for new banks.

Q.16 · Answer (A) extension
A file name's extension, the letters after the dot such as .txt or .docx, tells the file type.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Runs 'n Ruins
Sunil Gavaskar wrote 'Runs 'n Ruins' (1984) as well as 'Sunny Days'. 'Playing It My Way' is Sachin Tendulkar's autobiography and 'Democracy's XI' is by Rajdeep Sardesai.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 2025
The Union Budget 2020-21 set out to double milk processing capacity, from 53.5 million tonnes to 108 million tonnes, by 2025.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Ethernet port
An Ethernet (RJ-45) port takes the cable that connects a computer to a wired network.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Malaria
Malaria is spread by a vector, the female Anopheles mosquito. Pneumonia and mumps spread through droplets and cholera through contaminated water or food.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Uttar Pradesh
In December 2020 Uttar Pradesh began a pilot in Lucknow, with UPNEDA and the state's power utilities, for households to trade surplus rooftop solar power on a blockchain platform, the first in India and South Asia.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Anusuiya Uikey
Anusuiya Uikey became Governor of Chhattisgarh in July 2019. Bhupesh Baghel was the state's Chief Minister.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Lead acid cell
Lead-acid cells are large rechargeable batteries used in vehicles and inverters. Silver oxide, mercury and zinc-air cells are small button cells used in watches and hearing aids.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Lucknow
The Rumi Darwaza in Lucknow was built under Nawab Asaf-ud-Daula in 1784.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Odisha

In December 2020 Odisha's Chief Minister, Naveen Patnaik, announced a new hockey stadium at Rourkela, planned as India's biggest, for the 2023 Men's Hockey World Cup.

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